YEAR 11 GCSE HISTORY EXAM BOOSTER

Specification Overdue Radar & High-Probability Topic Booster

Paper 3: Conflict at Home and Abroad: the USA, 1954–75 (1HI0/33) • Edexcel GCSE (9–1) Examination Series 2018–2026

2-PAGE REVISION DOSSIER

⚠ **EXAMINER RADAR ALERT:** Pearson Edexcel rotates high-tariff topics. The 5 topics below have been either *completely unexamined* or *absent for 4+ exam series*.

TARGET: SUMMER 2026 / MOCK EXAMS

TOP 5 HIGH-PROBABILITY OVERDUE EXAM TOPICS

#1

NEVER EXAMINED (HIGH GAP)

Key topic 2: Protest, progress and radicalism, 1960–75 • 1 Progress 1960–62: Sit-ins and Freedom Rides

- The impact of the Greensboro sit-ins and the growth of the student movement.: Greensboro Sit-in (1960): Four Black college students sat at a segregated Woolworth's lunch counter, refusing to leave after being denied service.
- Rapid Spread: This action sparked a wave of sit-ins across the South, involving over 70,000 students and desegregating hundreds of public counters.
- SNCC Founded: The movement led directly to the creation of the Student Nonviolent Coordinating Committee (SNCC) to coordinate student protests.

Predicted Exam Prompt: Explain why was significant... [12m/16m]

#2

NEVER EXAMINED (HIGH GAP)

Key topic 2: Protest, progress and radicalism, 1960–75 • 1 Progress 1960–62: Sit-ins and Freedom Rides

- The causes, key events, and impact of the Freedom Rides, including white supremacist violence and the Anniston bus bombing (1961).: CORE Campaign: Activists rode interstate buses into the deep South to test federal rulings outlawing transit segregation.
- Anniston Bombing: An angry white mob firebombed a Freedom Riders' bus in Anniston, Alabama, and beat the escaping passengers.
- Federal Action: The extreme violence forced Attorney General Robert Kennedy to issue a strict ban on transit segregation.

Predicted Exam Prompt: Explain why was significant... [12m/16m]

#3

NEVER EXAMINED (HIGH GAP)

Key topic 2: Protest, progress and radicalism, 1960–75 • 1 Progress 1960–62: Sit-ins and Freedom Rides

- The desegregation of the University of Mississippi and the James Meredith case (1962).: Ole Miss Desegregation: James Meredith won a federal court order to enroll at the all-white University of Mississippi.
- Federal Force: Governor Ross Barnett physically blocked him, sparking riots that forced President Kennedy to send 30,000 federal troops to secure Meredith's safety.

Predicted Exam Prompt: Explain why was significant... [12m/16m]

#4

NEVER EXAMINED (HIGH GAP)

Key topic 4: Reactions to, and the end of, US involvement in the Vietnam War, 1964–75 • 3 Widening the war: Cambodia and Laos, and Kent State

- The historical significance and terms of the 1973 Paris Peace Agreement.: Ceasefire Terms: Negotiated the withdrawal of all US forces and the release of all prisoners of war, while allowing North Vietnamese troops to remain in the South.

Predicted Exam Prompt: Explain why was significant... [12m/16m]

#5

NEVER EXAMINED (HIGH GAP)

Key topic 4: Reactions to, and the end of, US involvement in the Vietnam War, 1964–75 • 3 Widening the war: Cambodia and Laos, and Kent State

- The human casualties and financial costs of the Vietnam War for the United States.: Human Loss: Over 58,000 US soldiers were killed, and more than 300,000 were wounded.
- Economic Damage: Spent over $167 billion, leading to severe inflation and starving domestic programs of funding.

Predicted Exam Prompt: Explain why was significant... [12m/16m]

⚡ RAPID RETRIEVAL HINGE CHECK (5 CORE QUESTIONS)

1 **Where did the 1960 lunch counter sit-in begin, and what store was targeted?**

Answer Key: Greensboro, North Carolina at the Woolworth's department store lunch counter.

2 **What new civil rights organization was founded in April 1960 directly as a result of the sit-ins?**

Answer Key: SNCC (Student Nonviolent Coordinating Committee), mentored by Ella Baker.

3 **What was the Gulf of Tonkin Resolution (1964), and why was it significant?**

Answer Key: A congressional resolution giving President Johnson authority to take "all necessary measures" in Vietnam without declaring war.

4 **Which 1970 event saw four unarmed student anti-war protesters shot dead by the National Guard?**

Answer Key: The Kent State University shootings in Ohio (4 May 1970).

5 **Name the 1965 civil rights march that was attacked on "Bloody Sunday" at the Edmund Pettus Bridge.**

Answer Key: The Selma to Montgomery march in Alabama.

GRADE 9 EXEMPLAR MODEL ANSWER

Explain why the sit-in movement of 1960 was significant in the civil rights campaign. (12 marks)

The Greensboro lunch counter sit-in launched by four Black college students in February 1960 represented a crucial tactical and psychological evolution in the civil rights movement, accelerating desegregation and empowering student youth.

PEEL Paragraph 1: Firstly, the sit-ins demonstrated the extraordinary power of non-violent direct action to achieve immediate desegregation in public accommodations. When Ezell Blair Jr., David Richmond, Franklin McCain, and Joseph McNeil refused to leave the whites-only counter at Woolworth's in Greensboro, North Carolina, their dignified discipline in the face of verbal abuse and food dumping attracted national media attention. Within days, the protest swelled to hundreds of students, and by July 1960 Woolworth's desegregated its lunch counters. The tactic rapidly spread across 55 cities in 13 Southern states involving over 70,000 participants, successfully integrating public facilities across the upper South far faster than courtroom lawsuits had achieved.

PEEL Paragraph 2: Secondly, the movement catalyzed the formation of the Student Nonviolent Coordinating Committee (SNCC), establishing young people as the frontline vanguard of the struggle. Under the guidance of veteran activist Ella Baker at Shaw University in April 1960, SNCC was founded to maintain student autonomy separate from Martin Luther King's SCLC and the NAACP. SNCC activists brought radical energy, organizational fearlessness, and grassroots focus to the movement, immediately going on to lead the 1961 Freedom Rides and the 1964 Freedom Summer voter registration campaigns in Mississippi.

PEEL Paragraph 3: Thirdly, the sit-ins mobilized economic pressure that forced commercial business owners to capitulate. Because Black customers represented a significant portion of downtown shopping revenue, selective buying boycotts organized alongside sit-ins cost Southern retailers millions of dollars in lost trade. Store owners recognized that maintaining segregation was economically ruinous, creating powerful commercial pressure that bypassed slow-moving Southern state legislatures.

⚠ CHIEF EXAMINER PITFALL WARNING:
Examiners note that candidates frequently describe the Greensboro sit-in as an isolated event without explaining its wider significance (e.g. the creation of SNCC, the contagion effect across 55 cities, and the direct link to the 1961 Freedom Rides). Always explain why the event mattered in the broader struggle.

PUPIL PRE-EXAM TRAFFIC LIGHT SELF-CHECK

Specification Overdue Topic	Core Facts Mastered?	Essay Plan Ready?
	[ ] Red [ ] Amber [ ] Green	[ ] Ready to write
	[ ] Red [ ] Amber [ ] Green	[ ] Ready to write
	[ ] Red [ ] Amber [ ] Green	[ ] Ready to write
	[ ] Red [ ] Amber [ ] Green	[ ] Ready to write
	[ ] Red [ ] Amber [ ] Green	[ ] Ready to write